ABAP INTERVIEW PREPARATION

ABAP practice workbook

Thirteen interview scenarios with model answers, a mock interview and a study plan

350 questions across 25 study segments. Reviewed 13 October 2026.

Use the short answers for oral rehearsal. The examples and pitfalls prepare you for follow-up questions. Choose the target SAP edition and release before applying an implementation detail.

Open abap-interview-studio.pages.dev online, or download the repository and open START_HERE.html for offline study. The PDF is a portable reading and printing edition.

Solve each exercise before opening the suggested answer. The scenarios are hypothetical interview exercises. Code fragments illustrate reasoning and are not activated SAP repository objects. Validate exact syntax, dependencies and release compatibility in a target SAP system before using a fragment in an application.

Exercise 1 Choose an internal table

You receive 100,000 unique order IDs. For each of 40,000 incoming messages, you must find the order by its complete ID. In another report you must process all orders for each customer in customer order. Choose a table category and explain the trade-offs.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

For the 40,000 complete order-ID lookups, I would consider a hashed table with a unique order-ID key. It can find the order without checking each row. For processing orders by customer, I would use a suitable sorted key. A standard table with a sorted secondary key can also work when I must keep the original file order.

I would measure the whole job, including loading and changing the table. Extra keys need memory and maintenance. A hashed table's fast complete-key lookup does not mean searching by any partial key is equally fast.

Follow-up

What changes when duplicate order IDs are permitted or only a partial key is known? Explain how you would handle a missing row without hiding a business error. Review ABAP-01 through ABAP-04.

Exercise 2 Find the data-access defect

An import selects details with FOR ALL ENTRIES using an internal table of selected document IDs. The selection table can be empty. The developer also assumes duplicate result rows will be preserved.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

First, check whether the list of document IDs is empty. If it is, do not run this FOR ALL ENTRIES query as though it meant 'select nothing': its WHERE condition is ignored, which can return far more data within the query's remaining implicit scope. Decide explicitly what the empty-input case should do.

FOR ALL ENTRIES also removes duplicate result rows. Check which columns the query returns and whether two different business records could therefore look identical. Compare a join, a range or another supported query with the same expected result. Removing duplicate input IDs can reduce work, but only do it if it preserves the intended result.

Follow-up

Do not promise that a join is always faster. Compare result equivalence, transferred rows, execution count and representative timings. Review the SQL segment.

Exercise 3 Correct a CDS identity

A flight entity exposes CARRID and CONNID as its only keys while reading SFLIGHT. It associates to SCARR using the carrier ID, declares a to-many relationship and projects `_Carrier.name`. The client occasionally confuses different departure dates.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Add FLDATE to the key: the same carrier and connection can have flights on different dates. Without the date, the client cannot reliably tell those departures apart. Use the actual SCARR field CARRNAME rather than guessing a field called name.

Check the association's ON condition and the data. One flight should match at most the intended carrier row; declaring a cardinality does not force the data to obey it. Likewise, a CDS key describes identity but does not create a database uniqueness check. For a new model on a release that supports it, prefer a CDS view entity and leave out the old SQL-view-name annotation.

Follow-up

Test multiple dates, a missing carrier and unexpected duplicate target rows. Decide DCL at the actual consumed entity. Review CDS-02, CDS-03, CDS-07 and CDS-11. This replaces the malformed illustrative CDS snippet in the original PDF rather than offering it as a ready-to-activate object.

Exercise 4 Repair RAP transaction ownership

A proposed action changes a request, attempts COMMIT ENTITIES, then would invoke a remote workflow. That nested commit violates the RAP runtime contract. The design also needs to reject invalid date ranges before persistence. The developer proposes moving the commit into the saver.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Remove COMMIT ENTITIES from the action. Moving it into the saver would still be wrong: behavior code must let RAP finish the transaction. Put the date check where RAP can reject an invalid request before it is saved. Use the appropriate behavior logic for values that need to be calculated.

Start the workflow through a supported mechanism tied to the committed request. Otherwise a workflow might start for a request that later fails to save. If an external ABAP program calls EML, that outer caller checks the modification results and calls COMMIT ENTITIES. A rollback in the local database cannot undo an ordinary remote workflow call.

Follow-up

Test invalid dates, a save failure and duplicate event delivery. A remote workflow call is not rolled back by the local database. Review RAP-04, RAP-05, BTP-07 and RICEFW-11.

Exercise 5 Read an EML response

A validation returns an error message in REPORTED but does not fill FAILED. A determination tries to fill FAILED. A create handler returns only the database key and loses the caller's content ID.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

In the validation, put the rejected instance in FAILED and its error message in REPORTED. The message should identify the right instance and, where relevant, the field and path. Sending an error message alone is not the same as rejecting the change.

A determination has no FAILED response. Use a supported validation, precheck or action for the expected rejection. For a create, return the required mapping between the caller's %cid and the created instance. Keep the complete RAP instance identity in responses, including draft or preliminary-key information when the operation needs it. Otherwise the caller may not know which record a result belongs to.

Follow-up

Explain %cid, %cid_ref, %tky and %pid without calling %tky a temporary key. For late numbering discuss preliminary-to-final mapping in ADJUST_NUMBERS. Review RAP-07 and RAP-10.

Exercise 6 Secure an approval action

An app hides the Approve button for ordinary users. Its DCL filters one base CDS entity, but the service uses a projection without its own access control. An ordinary user can call the action URL directly.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Add a backend permission check for Approve. A hidden button does not stop someone from sending the request directly. Separately use feature control to express whether approval is available in the request's current state.

Protect reads of the projection that the service actually uses. Do not assume the base entity's DCL automatically applies there; use the appropriate rules or supported explicit inheritance. Test an ordinary user reading another company's known key and calling Approve directly. Also check service access and any downstream API permissions. A value help or hidden field is not a security check.

Follow-up

Would authorization: none or IN LOCAL MODE fix the bug? No: those deliberately bypass relevant checks in their defined contexts and require justification. Review CDS-07, ADV-02 and TEST-06.

Exercise 7 Classify Clean Core dependencies

Classify these hypothetical cases. Assume the stated release or nomination is verified for the target system; do not infer it from a name.

Case	Model classification and reasoning
ABAP Cloud extension using the appropriate released SAP APIs and released extension points	A for those dependencies and technologies
Classic code calling an API SAP has nominated as classic	B for that dependency
Read access to an internal SAP object that is neither released nor nominated and is not explicitly prohibited	C with upgrade risk and governance
Unsupported direct write to an SAP business table	D risk; replace with the supported business operation
Released custom wrapper calling a nominated classic API	The consumer sees a released custom contract; the underlying implementation still carries B dependency
BTP app using an unsupported private endpoint	Placement does not establish compliance; classify the actual dependency and remedy it

Follow-up

State the ATC mapping: A no corresponding usage finding, B priority 3, C priority 2, D priority 1. Explain why an ordinary security error in ATC is a different dimension. Review CORE-02 through CORE-16.

Exercise 8 Diagnose a failed batch and stale update

An OData batch returns HTTP 200 but one inner response is 412. The UI reports success and the developer retries with If-Match set to a wildcard.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Open the batch response and inspect each inner result. The outer 200 does not mean every operation succeeded. The inner 412 says a precondition failed; a stale ETag is a common cause. Read the current record and resolve the user's conflicting edit.

Do not automatically replace If-Match with a wildcard just to make the update succeed. That can remove protection against overwriting someone else's change. Check which operations belong to the same changeset or atomicity group and therefore succeed or fail together. Other groups in the same batch can have a different outcome.

Follow-up

Explain why one batch can contain separate transaction scopes and why a CSRF token does not replace an ETag. Review ODATA-06 through ODATA-09.

Exercise 9 Build a reliable approval flow

A committed request event is delivered twice. Approval later arrives after the requester has withdrawn the document. The callback times out after the backend accepted it.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Store a stable request/event identifier so the same event does not start the workflow twice. When an approval arrives, check the request's current status, version and approver. If the request has been withdrawn, the old approval must not move it forward.

If the backend accepted a callback but its reply was lost, a retry should recognize the same decision and return the agreed result. A timeout means 'we do not yet know the outcome', not 'nothing happened'. Check the recorded outcome before repeating an irreversible action. Give support staff a way to find failed deliveries and retry only the work that is safe to repeat.

Follow-up

Draw the boundary between the local RAP transaction, event delivery, external workflow and callback transaction. Review RICEFW-11 through RICEFW-14 and BTP-08.

Exercise 10 Explain and test a refactoring

A report method selects data, calculates discounts, writes a file and commits the transaction. It uses a singleton for the current date and a nested SELECT in every item loop. What would you do first?

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

First, record what the report currently does and who controls its commit. Protect those behaviors with focused tests before changing the design. Move the discount calculation into code that can be tested without selecting data or writing a file. Pass in a clock when tests need to control the date.

Measure how many database calls the nested SELECT produces. Then change the read strategy while checking that the same business rows and output remain. Keep the commit with the correct transaction owner. Test missing data, discount limits and file-write failure as well as the successful run. Small verified changes make faults easier to locate.

Follow-up

Test discount boundaries, missing data, file failure and rollback behavior. Report which tests were actually run and which need the target system. Review OO-07, OO-13, TEST-01 and TEST-10.

Exercise 11 Recover from an uncertain HTTP result

Your ABAP caller sends a create-order request with JSON. The service commits the order, but the connection times out before the response arrives. The retry job proposes sending the same request again with no correlation identifier.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Do not assume the timeout means creation failed. The service may already have saved the order. Look it up using a stable business identifier, or use the API's supported idempotency key so repeating the same request does not create a second order.

Before retrying, establish the original outcome as far as the API allows. Check the response status and error body when a response does arrive. Send the required Content-Type and preserve the payload's meaning: a customer number such as 00123 may need to stay a string. An omitted field, JSON null and an empty string can request different behavior.

Follow-up

What if the service returns 202? Explain how completion is observed. Explain why converting the JSON body to XML is a contract change, not just a header change. Review HTTP-01 through HTTP-12 and BTP-07.

Exercise 12 Make a parallel background job restartable

A classic background job sends three independent work partitions through aRFC. Worker A commits, B fails and C is still running when the coordinator times out. An operator wants to rerun the whole job.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Give each partition a stable ID and record what it actually completed. Worker A's committed changes remain even if the coordinator rolls back. Check B's failure and find out whether C finished after the timeout before rerunning either one.

Collect callbacks and RFC exceptions, and save checkpoints under a clear transaction design. Make unfinished work safe to repeat without duplicating completed business changes. Limit the number of workers to available resources and avoid sending overlapping locked records to different workers. Also check how the chosen WAIT and task-processing statements affect the database LUW. A finished job status alone does not prove every business item succeeded.

Follow-up

Distinguish the job scheduler from parallel execution. Explain the roles of SM36/SM37 in a classic landscape and application-job templates in supported cloud scenarios. State why job status and business item success are separate evidence. Review RFC-05 through RFC-12.

Exercise 13 Diagnose an IDoc or AIF error before resubmission

An inbound integration reports a mapping or application error. The business user sees the message in a configured AIF monitor. A similar earlier message already created a business document. An operator proposes repeated resubmission until the status turns green.

Your answer before reading the solution

Model answer

Find the incoming message, its external business key and any document already created for that key. Check the IDoc control, data and status records, then the processing details shown by the configured AIF monitor. This tells you whether transport, mapping or business posting failed.

Fix the cause with the required permission, then use the mechanism that owns reprocessing. Before resubmitting, make sure the earlier message has not already produced the same business effect. Keep a record of the diagnosis and retry. AIF helps monitor and handle errors; it does not replace the underlying IDoc or OData processing rules.

Follow-up

Explain how the diagnosis changes for transport hand-off versus application posting failure. Distinguish OData service semantics, IDoc asynchronous message processing and AIF monitoring/error handling. Review INTF-01 through INTF-12.

A 60 minute mock interview

Time	Interviewer prompt	What a strong response includes
0 to 5 minutes	Introduce yourself and one real project	Your actual role, constraint and outcome
5 to 12 minutes	Choose table types and explain a missing lookup	Key semantics, mutation and error handling
12 to 20 minutes	Diagnose a slow report	Evidence, SQL volume, access pattern and correctness
20 to 32 minutes	Design a request BO with draft and approval	Composition, transaction owner, messages and concurrency
32 to 40 minutes	Explain Clean Core levels and a missing API	Target edition, classification, options and governance
40 to 48 minutes	Discuss an OData or workflow failure	Protocol, retries, atomicity and security
48 to 55 minutes	Explain testing and deployment	Real evidence, negative tests, dependencies and limits
55 to 60 minutes	Ask questions about the role	Landscape, ownership, quality process and expectations

Score the interview

Score eight technical responses from 0 to 3. A 0 is wrong or missing; 1 is a definition with important gaps; 2 is correct with an example; 3 adds a relevant trade-off, failure mode and validation approach. Treat the score as a self-assessment rather than a hiring prediction. Choose the three weakest topics and repeat different questions from them tomorrow.

Personal story worksheet

For each of five real examples, write: business problem; my responsibility; constraints; options considered; decision; testing evidence; result; what I learned. Use this for a delivered feature, a defect, a performance problem, an integration and a disagreement about design. Use only outcomes and measurements that actually occurred.

Extension placement reference

Choose an extension approach

Start with the business requirement, supported contracts and transaction boundary

First	**Can standard functionality or configuration meet the need?**	Use the standard capability and avoid unnecessary custom code.
Key user	**Does a delivered business context cover the adaptation?**	Use supported custom fields, logic or UI adaptation tools.
On-stack	**Does the logic need local transactional consistency?**	Use released local contracts and suitable ABAP Cloud extensibility.
Side-by-side	**Does the process need an independent or cross-system app?**	Use supported remote APIs and events; design retries and consistency.

Placement does not determine the Clean Core level. Check dependencies separately.

Study plan

The studio contains 350 questions across 10 topics, 121 authored multiple-choice challenges and 28 guided lessons. It is a library you can explore freely, with short recommended paths when you want a starting point. A path introduces a topic; it does not cover every question or establish production readiness.

Start with your goal

- **Learn the basics** opens the ABAP topic and its suggested path with the Core filter. Use it when you want to build an explanation from smaller concepts and examples. - **Prepare for an interview** opens Practice with all levels. Explain a familiar topic without notes, then use the answer and feedback to find your gaps.

You can change direction at any time. Optional prerequisite links help you find background material; they never lock questions or require a passing score.

Choose the right level

Learning level	What to aim for
Core: basics	Explain one concept and predict a small example.
Applied: application	Choose an approach, read its code and find a typical mistake.
Advanced: complex scenarios	Reason about interacting mechanisms, failure boundaries and trade-offs.

These describe the learning task, not your job title. A Core question can still have demanding interview follow-ups. The original Senior interview criteria remain useful for deeper discussion; they are separate from the learning level.

Use the level filter in Learn or Practice to narrow the library. Choose **Recommended order** for a concept-building sequence, or **Question ID** to find a known item. The global search remains a way to find material across the full library, including questions outside the current filters.

Follow a short path

Each topic has an optional path of six to eight questions, with a stated goal. Read the named next question to continue the path, or follow a prerequisite when the explanation assumes something unfamiliar. Visited questions indicate where you have been, **not what you have mastered**.

Use the ABAP path for language and object-oriented foundations. For RAP, establish what a business object contains and how its buffer works before reasoning about save processing. CDS, integration, Clean Core, performance and testing paths offer their own starting points; you do not need to finish the whole library before studying a topic relevant to your work.

The app reads the maintained sequences and goals from `curriculum/learning.json`. Use the app to follow the current question links rather than treating a module number or alphabetical ID order as a learning dependency.

Study one example actively

1. Read the question and try a short answer before revealing the explanation. 2. Read the short answer. Identify the one idea the example should demonstrate. 3. Before advancing a code or process step, predict the value, saved state or error you expect. Keep the same example in mind as you move between views. 4. Compare the prediction with the actual example and its explanation. If it differs, identify the exact rule or assumption you missed. 5. Read the important mistake and open deeper details when the question needs them. Explain the concept again in your own words, using a different value or failure condition.

Use Explanation for the concept, Code for an implementation example and Step by step where a guided lesson is available. Not every question needs all three. An excerpt explains a particular mechanism; read its stated context before assuming it is a complete program or valid for your SAP release.

Check understanding, then revisit gaps

Interview practice lets you answer aloud, reveal the model answer and self-rate your explanation. It does not record a microphone or grade speech. Multiple-choice practice is available for the 121 questions with authored choices; it gives feedback after submission. The two formats measure different things: recognizing an option does not prove you can explain the decision without prompts.

At the end of a learning path, review its questions in Practice. Use an available quiz or guided example as an additional check. Explain why an alternative fails, not only why your chosen answer works. Review a weak answer again on a later day and change the example to check whether you understood the rule.

Choose a session you can finish attentively rather than a fixed daily duration. Retry mistakes, return to missing prerequisites and save questions you want to revisit. The app keeps local study progress where browser storage is available; it does not provide scheduled spaced repetition or cross-device account sync. Opening a question, a correct quiz answer and a strong spoken explanation are different kinds of evidence.

Prepare a stronger interview answer

After the basic explanation, add the constraint that changes your decision, an alternative you rejected and a meaningful way to verify the result. Use Advanced questions and optional Senior probes for that discussion. If a scenario exposes a foundation gap, follow its prerequisite instead of memorizing a longer answer.

For project stories, distinguish a learning exercise from production experience. State the business context, your own role, decision, verification and actual outcome. Do not invent measurements or claim work you did not perform.

Before discussing a concrete SAP implementation, establish the edition, release, ABAP language version, API release status and relevant consumer version. The teaching example and the date of this guide do not establish feature availability on every system.

Optional study formats

The repository also contains printable guides, the visual gallery and Anki decks under `flashcards/`. These are optional companions to the web app. See the editorial guide for how the learning levels, paths and examples are maintained.